History of Australia (1768–1901)

KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL & HOMEWORK COMPANION • 30 HIGH-YIELD QUESTIONS

Pupil Name: _____ **Class:** _____ **Teacher:** _____



The departure of the First Fleet from Portsmouth in May 1787 • Eleven vessels carrying over 1,400 convicts, marines, and civilian officials to establish the penal colony of New South Wales.

LESSON ENQUIRY FOCUS	HW DUE DATE	1. SOLO (WRITTEN)	2. PARTNER (VERBAL)	PARENT / TEACHER SIGN
Enquiry 1: Cook, Tupaia & Terra Nullius Endeavour expedition, Transit of Venus, Tupaia's Polynesian navigation, Botany Bay landing & the myth of Terra Nullius		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 2: The First Fleet & Penal Colony Loss of American colonies, prison hulks, 11 ships of First Fleet, Arthur Phillip, Sydney Cove & Starvation Years		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 3: Frontier Warfare & Pemulwuy Eora Nation, 1789 smallpox epidemic (Galgala), kidnapping of Bennelong, Pemulwuy's Bidjigal resistance & Battle of Parramatta		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 4: Pastoral Expansion & Black War Blue Mountains crossing, Merino wool boom, squatters seizing land, Van Diemen's Land Black War, Black Line & Myall Creek Massacre		/ 6	/ 6	
Enquiry 5: Gold Rush, Eureka & Federation 1851 Victorian Gold Rush, Chinese diggers and anti-Chinese racism, Eureka Stockade rebellion, secret ballot & 1901 Federation		/ 6	/ 6	

HOW TO COMPLETE YOUR RETRIEVAL CYCLES:

1. SOLO (WRITTEN): Complete your 6 write-in lines from memory without looking. Check your answers in green pen using the Department Marking Bank on Pages 7–8.

2. PARTNER (VERBAL): Hand your booklet to a **PARENT, CARER, FAMILY MEMBER, OR STUDY BUDDY** to test you out loud from the Marking Bank until you hit 6/6!

Scan for Interactive Digital Quizzes & Audio Lessons:
Access online self-marking retrieval flashcards, diagnostic feedback, and audio narration at the-history-revision-hub.netlify.app.

Enquiry 1: Cook, Tupaia & Terra Nullius

What is the significance of Captain Cook's voyage on the Endeavour in 1768 for colonisation?

QUESTIONS 1–6

1768 Endeavour Departs → 1769 Tupaia Joins in Tahiti → Apr 1770 Botany Bay Landing → Aug 1770 Possession Island Claim → 1770s Terra Nullius Adopted

1. What was the public scientific purpose of Captain Cook's 1768 voyage on the Endeavour?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

2. What secret orders did the British Admiralty give Captain Cook regarding new lands?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

3. Why was the Polynesian high priest and master navigator Tupaia essential to Cook's voyage?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

4. What encounter took place when Cook's landing party first stepped ashore at Botany Bay in April 1770?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

5. How did the legal fiction of "Terra Nullius" justify British claims to eastern Australia without a treaty?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

6. Why is Captain Cook's flag-raising at Possession Island in August 1770 viewed as a catastrophic turning point by First Nations?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Endeavour | Transit of Venus | Tupaia | Kamay (Botany Bay) | Possession Island | Terra Nullius

1783 American Exile Ends → **May 1787** First Fleet Sails → **Jan 1788** Sydney Cove Founded → **1788–90** Starvation Years → **1790** Second Fleet Arrives

7. ► **Why did the British government decide to establish a penal colony in Australia in 1786?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

8. ► **How many ships comprised the First Fleet led by Captain Arthur Phillip in May 1787?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

9. ►► **Why did Governor Arthur Phillip abandon Botany Bay within days of arrival in January 1788?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

10. ►► **What severe hardships characterised the "Starvation Years" (1788–1790) for the fledgling colony?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

11. ►►► **How did the convict assignment system transform Australian colonial society into a distinct socio-economic order?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

12. ►►► **Why did the arrival of the Second Fleet in 1790 earn the grim title of the "Death Fleet"?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | First Fleet | Prison Hulks | Transportation | Arthur Phillip | Sydney Cove | Emancipists

Enquiry 3: Frontier Warfare & Pemulwuy

Was the colonisation of Australia a story of 'amity and kindness' or violent frontier resistance?

QUESTIONS 13–18

Jan 1788 Eora Observe Landing → Apr 1789 Smallpox (Galgala) Outbr… → Nov 1789 Bennelong Kidnapped → 1790 Phillip Speared at Manly → 1797 Battle of Parramatta

13. ► **What catastrophic epidemic struck the Eora and neighbouring Indigenous nations around Sydney in April 1789?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

14. ► **Why did Governor Phillip order the kidnapping of Eora men like Arabanoo and Bennelong in 1788–1789?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

15. ►► **How did Bennelong navigate his complex diplomatic role between British colonial authorities and Eora society?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

16. ►► **Why did Pemulwuy, a Bidjigal warrior of the Eora nation, launch a twelve-year guerrilla war against British settlements?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

17. ►►► **What was the historical significance of the 1797 Battle of Parramatta?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

18. ►►► **How does the story of early Sydney challenge Governor Phillip's royal instructions to live in "amity and kindness"?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Eora Nation | Smallpox (Galgala) | Bennelong | Pemulwuy | Bidjigal Clan | Battle of Parramatta

1813 Blue Mountains Crossed → **1820s** Merino Wool Boom → **1828** Martial Law in Tasmania → **1830** The "Black Line" Sweep → **1838** Myall Creek Massacre Tria

19. ► **What major geographical barrier was crossed in 1813, opening the vast interior plains of New South Wales to grazing?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

20. ► **Which industry became the primary economic engine of colonial Australia in the 1820s and 1830s?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

21. ►► **Who were the colonial "squatters" and why did they come into violent conflict with Indigenous peoples?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

22. ►► **What was the "Black War" fought in Van Diemen's Land (Tasmania) between 1824 and 1831?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

23. ►►► **Why was the 1830 "Black Line" in Tasmania considered a military failure but an ideological turning point?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

24. ►►► **Why was the trial and hanging of seven white stockmen after the 1838 Myall Creek Massacre a historic legal landmark?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: | Blue Mountains | Merino Wool | Squatters | Black War | The Black Line | Myall Creek |

1851 Ballarat Gold Discovered → Dec 1854 Eureka Stockade Battle → 1856 Secret Ballot Adopted → 1861 Lambing Flat Riots → 1901 Federation & White Austr...

25. ► **What major event in 1851 transformed Australia from a quiet penal colony into a magnet for global migration?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

26. ► **What grievance sparked the armed uprising of gold miners at the Eureka Stockade in Ballarat in December 1854?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

27. ►► **Why did Chinese gold miners face severe discrimination and violent hostility on the Victorian and NSW goldfields?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

28. ►► **How did the Eureka Stockade directly accelerate the growth of parliamentary democracy in Australia?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

29. ►►► **How did the rapid economic wealth and population influx of the Gold Rush hasten the end of convict transportation?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

30. ►►► **How did the 1901 Federation of the Australian colonies combine democratic self-determination with institutionalised exclusion?**

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Gold Rush | Eureka Stockade | Southern Cross | Peter Lalor | Secret Ballot | White Australia Policy

Department Marking Bank • Part 1

Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 1 to 3 (Questions 1 to 18)

ENQUIRIES 1–3

ENQUIRY 1: COOK, TUPAIA & TERRA NULLIUS

1. ► **To observe the transit of Venus across the Sun in Tahiti** — *The Royal Society sponsored the voyage to calculate the solar system's scale, masking secret orders to search for the Southern Continent.* [✓] [✗]

2. ► **To search for the Great Southern Continent and claim it with native consent** — *The Admiralty ordered Cook to cultivate friendship and take possession with consent, an instruction Cook ignored when claiming sovereignty.* [✓] [✗]

3. ►► **He navigated thousands of miles using star lore and translated with Māori leaders** — *Tupaia drew a master chart of 74 Pacific islands and acted as an indispensable interpreter between British sailors and Polynesian societies.* [✓] [✗]

4. ►► **Two Gweagal warriors opposed the landing with spears, and the British fired muskets, wounding one** — *Despite warning shouts to leave ("Warra Warra Wai"), Cook ordered shots fired, demonstrating early Indigenous defiance of intrusion.* [✓] [✗]

5. ►►► **By declaring the continent "nobody's land" because Aboriginal peoples did not practise European agriculture** — *British legal doctrine falsely classified hunter-gatherers as lacking property rights, denying Indigenous sovereignty without conquest.* [✓] [✗]

6. ►►► **It initiated the legal dispossession of First Nations peoples from lands held for over 65,000 years** — *Cook claimed the eastern coastline for King George III without consent, laying the legal foundation for frontier warfare and cultural destruction.* [✓] [✗]

ENQUIRY 2: THE FIRST FLEET & PENAL COLONY

7. ► **The American Revolution ended convict transportation to North America, overcrowding British gaols** — *Britain had banished 50,000 convicts to America; losing the colonies forced Lord Sydney to choose Botany Bay to relieve crowded prison hulks.* [✓] [✗]

8. ► **11 ships carrying roughly 1,480 people, including over 750 convicts** — *The armada included two warships, six convict transports, and three store ships, sailing 15,000 miles over 252 days with low mortality.* [✓] [✗]

9. ►► **Botany Bay was shallow, exposed to open gales, and lacked an adequate fresh water supply** — *Phillip scouted north to Port Jackson, finding "the finest natural harbour in the world" and fresh water at Sydney Cove on 26 January 1788.* [✓] [✗]

10. ►► **Poor sandy soil, failed European crops, lost supply ships, and rations cut to near-starvation levels** — *Cattle escaped into the bush, convicts lacked farming skills, and the supply ship Guardian wrecked, pushing the settlement to the brink.* [✓] [✗]

11. ►►► **By distributing convict labourers to free settlers, allowing pardoned "emancipists" to acquire land** — *Unlike enslaved people, convicts had fixed terms; upon release, emancipists became prosperous farmers and merchants, challenging elites.* [✓] [✗]

12. ►►► **Private contractors starved and chained convicts to maximize profits, causing over 270 deaths at sea** — *Contractors were paid per convict boarded rather than delivered alive; hundreds arrived dying of scurvy and typhus, horrifying Governor Phillip.* [✓] [✗]

ENQUIRY 3: FRONTIER WARFARE & PEMULWUY

13. ► **A catastrophic smallpox epidemic known as Galgala, killing 50% to 70% of First Nations** — *Indigenous Australians had no natural immunity to the virus; bodies were found in rock caves, shattering traditional social structures.* [✓] [✗]

14. ► **To force them to learn English and serve as diplomatic intermediaries between British settlers and clans** — *Eora clans initially avoided the British; Phillip used capture as a colonial policy to learn Aboriginal customs, language, and geography.* [✓] [✗]

15. ►► **By adopting European dress and visiting King George III in London, while preserving his cultural identity** — *Bennelong lived in a brick hut at Sydney Cove, acted as cultural adviser to Phillip, but frequently returned to the bush and defended protocols.* [✓] [✗]

16. ►► **In response to British land clearing, destruction of hunting grounds, and violence against clans** — *After gamekeeper John McIntyre was speared for attacking Indigenous people, Pemulwuy organized coordinated raids on colonial outposts.* [✓] [✗]

17. ►►► **It was the first major pitched battle of the Frontier Wars, where Pemulwuy led 100 warriors against troops** — *Although shot seven times, Pemulwuy survived and escaped from hospital, earning mythical status among clans as an invincible resistance leader.* [✓] [✗]

18. ►►► **Imperial expansion relied on military force, punitive expeditions, and violent dispossession when resisted** — *While early policy claimed benevolence, British authorities rapidly deployed punitive detachments with orders to shoot and decapitate resistors.* [✓] [✗]

Department Marking Bank • Part 2

Green-Pen Verification Key • Enquiries 4 to 5 (Questions 19 to 30)

ENQUIRIES 4–5

ENQUIRY 4: PASTORAL EXPANSION & BLACK WAR

19. ► **The Blue Mountains, crossed by Blaxland, Lawson, and Wentworth** — *Finding a ridge route allowed settlers to escape coastal drought and access millions of acres of fertile western grazing pastures.* [✓] [X]

20. ► **Merino sheep farming and fine wool exports to British textile mills** — *Pioneered by John Macarthur, Australian wool replaced German imports in Leeds and Manchester, driving rapid inland expansion.* [✓] [X]

21. ►► **Wealthy pastoralists who occupied Crown land without leases** — *Sheep destroyed native yam daisy crops and polluted billabongs, cutting off First Nations from food and provoking frontier raids.* [✓] [X]

22. ►► **A brutal war of survival between British settlers and Tasmanian Aboriginal clans** — *Governor Arthur declared martial law in 1828, authorizing armed settlers to shoot Aboriginal people on sight across Tasmania.* [✓] [X]

23. ►►► **Over 2,000 armed settlers formed a human chain across Tasmania but captured only two people** — *The military failure convinced Governor Arthur to negotiate forced exile to Flinders Island under false promises of safety.* [✓] [X]

24. ►►► **The first time white settlers were executed for murdering Aboriginal people** — *Stockmen killed 28 unarmed Wirrayaraay people; despite fierce colonial outcry, judge Burton enforced equal protection under law.* [✓] [X]

ENQUIRY 5: GOLD RUSH, EUREKA & FEDERATION

25. ► **The 1851 Australian Gold Rush in New South Wales and Victoria** — *Discoveries tripled the population in a decade as fortune-seekers ("diggers") arrived from Britain, Ireland, America, and China.* [✓] [X]

26. ► **Expensive monthly mining licences enforced by police, with no voting rights** — *Miners burned licences and built a wooden stockade at Ballarat under the Southern Cross flag to defend their democratic liberties.* [✓] [X]

27. ►► **European diggers resented their collective work success, sparking anti-Chinese riots** — *Mobs attacked Chinese camps at Lambing Flat, driving discriminatory taxes and laws that led to the 1901 White Australia Policy.* [✓] [X]

28. ►► **By forcing Victoria to abolish licences, introduce cheap miners' rights, and grant the vote** — *Rebel leader Peter Lalor was elected to parliament, leading Victoria to adopt the secret ballot, later copied worldwide.* [✓] [X]

29. ►►► **Free settlers demanded self-government and refused to accept convict labour** — *Exiling convicts to a prosperous gold-rush colony destroyed transportation's deterrent effect, prompting successful boycotts.* [✓] [X]

30. ►►► **While uniting the colonies into a Commonwealth, the constitution excluded First Nations** — *The 1901 Constitution excluded Aboriginal people from the census, while immigration laws institutionalised a "White Australia".* [✓] [X]

UNIT CONCEPTUAL FOUNDATIONS • 4 CORE ANCHORS

TERRA NULLIUS: 'Nobody's land'; the legal fiction used by the British Crown to claim Australia without treaties or recognising native ownership.

FIRST NATIONS: Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples holding continuous sovereignty and sacred Songlines for over 65,000 years.

TRANSPORTATION: Judicial exile of British convicts to overseas penal colonies for 7 years, 14 years, or life for forced infrastructure labour.

FRONTIER RESISTANCE: Protracted armed resistance of Indigenous clans against pastoral expansion, stockmen violence, and martial law.